



Video transcript

Information Assurance

Expert Insights – Security analytics

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SPEAKER 1: What sort of IT innovations do you think CIOs are engaging with here in Malaysia?

JASON YUEN: I think one of the biggest areas of innovation really is how we're going to use analytics and data. And maybe if I want to zoom in, analytics and data in terms of cybersecurity. So somebody hears that we are engaging with clients and they're very interested about, how can we use analytics as an early warning trigger, as well as to understand how we can find security incidents.

Let me explain that a bit more. I'll give you an example. Everyone typically has a normal behaviour. So, for example, I myself-- how Jason comes into the office, where he'll walk, what he'll do when he first comes in. You know, I'll access my email. When do I typically work? When do I not work? So for example, Jason almost never logs in on Saturday morning. Right. So I only start working again on Sunday night.

But you see, how we can apply analytics is really by understanding that behaviour and triggering actions. The typical areas of security, when we look at, if I log-in with my correct username and my password, it's assumed that everything I do is correct. But what we found is from a lot of security incidents, the hackers and the bad guys, when they take over your accounts, they never fail a username and password log-in. They already have your username and password log-in.

So how analytics can work coming back to my example-- if I see a log-in from Jason-- say Jason logs in on Saturday morning, but Jason never logs in. He doesn't fail his password test. He gives a perfect password. Even if you have something like two-factor authentication, he passes that as well.

What analytics can do is that it can trigger that this is an abnormal action, and therefore I should look at it. It doesn't mean it's not Jason, but hey, these are areas that we need to look at a bit more and potentially trigger, is this really Jason? Is this a bad guy who's trying to access my network and so forth? So I think analytics is sort of like the next generation of warning to allow us to identify security incidents.

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